



# Grant Opportunities & Applications

---

**Who:** *Vendors who receive Grants*

---

---

**What:** *Overview for grantee registration and functionality in SIGMA Vendor Self Service (VSS)*

---

## Table of Contents

|                                        |    |
|----------------------------------------|----|
| Introduction.....                      | 1  |
| Section 1: SIGMA VSS Users .....       | 2  |
| Section 2: SIGMA VSS Commodities ..... | 4  |
| Section 3: Grant Opportunities .....   | 6  |
| 3.1 My Watch List .....                | 8  |
| 3.2 Award History .....                | 8  |
| Section 4: Grant Applications .....    | 9  |
| 4.1 My Grant Applications .....        | 9  |
| 4.2 Events Schedule Search.....        | 10 |
| 4.3 Grant Reports .....                | 11 |
| Section 5: Financial Inquiries.....    | 13 |
| 5.1 Financial Inquiries .....          | 13 |
| 5.2 Agreements .....                   | 13 |
| 5.2.1 Create Request (GFR).....        | 13 |
| 5.3 Scheduled Payments .....           | 15 |
| 5.4 Checks/EFTs .....                  | 15 |
| 5.5 Invoice Summary Page.....          | 15 |



## Introduction

This guide provides an overview for grantee registration and functionality in SIGMA Vendor Self Service (VSS). This guide is to be utilized by those who have been awarded a grant by the State of Michigan and have not registered on SIGMA VSS, are unsure if they have an existing account in SIGMA VSS, and for potential grantees wishing to view on-line grant opportunities in SIGMA VSS.

The SIGMA VSS website allows institutions and individuals to register and maintain grantee account information. Grant Opportunities for some State Agencies are published within the grant portal of the SIGMA VSS page. Some State Agencies may continue to utilize their existing systems.

For detailed information related to the SIGMA VSS Registration process and how to view and submit financial transactions, view the related **Download Vendor Guides** on the [SIGMA VSS](#) login page (prior to logging in).



## Section 1: SIGMA VSS Users

1. Log into your SIGMA vendor account.
  - If you are not an existing SIGMA vendor / user please use the link in the Introduction above and click **Download Vendor Guides**.
2. Once logged into your SIGMA account, click **My Account** from the Account Summary section on the home page.
3. Click the **Users** tab to update or setup users to allow for various access privileges such as review grant opportunities, respond to grant opportunities, and accept awards.
  - a. To set up a user, click **Add User**. Then complete required fields.
  - b. To edit a user, click the transaction-level **3-dot menu**, **Edit**, then **Access Levels**.
  - c. From here you can update primary and optional access levels.
4. Then click **Save & Close**.

**Primary Access Level** – indicates what the user can do in SIGMA VSS. All users must have a Primary Access Level set to one of the following values:

- **Account Administrator**
  - Ability to add account users, assign access levels to each user, and reset passwords.
  - May update the Account Information and User's information.
  - Ability to view financial transactions pertaining to the account.
  - Ability to update their own profile information.
- **Full Access**
  - May update the account information other than User Information.
  - Ability to view financial transactions pertaining to the account.
  - Ability to update their own profile information.
- **Display Only**
  - May view the Account Information other than User Information.
  - May view financial transactions pertaining to the account.
  - Ability to update their own profile information.



The account administrator can change each user's primary access level by choosing between Account Administrator, Full Access, and Display Only. Then click Save and Close.

**Optional Access Levels** – indicate what the user can do within the Financial Inquiries page in VSS. These optional levels may be assigned to the Full Access level and Accounting Administrator roles listed above. A user can optionally be assigned to one or more of the following access levels:

- **Create Invoice** - users have the ability to search for awarded grant agreements and create an invoice (financial reimbursement request).
- **Create Solicitation Response/Grant Funding Application** – users have the ability to create a response to available grant opportunity postings (grant application). The Create Solicitation Response/Grant Funding Application access level allows the creation and modification of both draft and submitted responses.
- **Submit Solicitation Response/Grant Funding Application** - users have the ability to submit a response to available grant opportunity postings (grant application). This also covers being able to submit grant transactions. The Submit Solicitation Response/Grant Funding Application access level allows the modification, withdrawal, and submission of both draft and submitted responses.
- **Query Tax Information** - Querying Tax Information will allow a user to view tax information for their account



## Section 2: SIGMA VSS Commodities

Click the **Commodities** tab to add a commodity/service or to update your existing commodities. SIGMA VSS utilizes commodity codes to post Grant Opportunities by a particular award program.

You will receive automated email notices whenever grant opportunities are published with the commodity codes selected for this account.

Notifications will be sent electronically for all Grant Opportunities within the Commodity Code you have chosen. For example, if you choose a higher level of commodity code such as G03, you will receive notifications for any grant opportunities that are posted within that entire structure.

If you choose a specific grant commodity code that is down to the specific grant opportunity, you will only receive that grant opportunity and no other grant opportunities.

You may choose more than one Commodity Code; however, there is no option to choose all grant related commodity codes. You need to choose the specific ones.

Some grant coordinators may have grant commodity codes specific to an application year, therefore if you only choose that grant commodity code, you may not receive notification if they change the grant commodity code the following year. It would be best to select at a broader level to receive all related grant opportunity notifications.

The Grant Commodity Structure was designed to cover basic grant categories, similar to the available search Categories listed on Grants.gov. The sequence is as follows:

- G01 – Agriculture
- G02 – Arts
- G03 – Business and Commerce
- G04 – Community Development
- G05 – Consumer Protection
- G06 – Disaster Prevention and Relief
- G07 – Education
- G08 – Employment, Labor and Training
- G09 – Energy
- G10 – Environment
- G11 – Food and Nutrition
- G12 – Health
- G13 – Housing
- G14 – Humanities



- G15 – Income Security and Social Services
- G16 – Information and Statistics
- G17 – Law, Justice and Legal Services
- G18 – Natural Resources
- G19 – Other
- G20 – Regional Development
- G21 – Science and Technology and other R&D
- G22 – Transportation

To update Commodities:

1. Within My Account, click the Commodities tab, then click **Add Commodity/Service**.
2. Search for Grant Commodities by selecting the Grant option **Yes**.
3. Select **Search** to return all grant related commodity codes.
4. Check the box(es) for the desired grant commodity codes for which you would like to receive notifications to apply.
5. Select **OK**.
  - These commodity codes will be added under View Pending Additions. Updates to your account will be reflected after VSS has completed its routine automated update cycle. The automated update cycle runs every two (2) hours 8 AM to 4 PM EST during State of Michigan business days. Some State Agencies may continue to utilize their existing systems and not SIGMA VSS.



## Section 3: Grant Opportunities

The State of Michigan may post grant opportunities to potential grantees using SIGMA VSS. These opportunities are available for viewing by both registered and non-registered SIGMA VSS users.

Once logged into SIGMA VSS, select the **View Grant Opportunities** quick link from the home page. This page will show existing State of Michigan grant opportunities that are available. The page displayed will show grant opportunities with details related to the grant, department, when the grant was published, and when it will be closing.

1. Show Me - To search for a specific grant opportunity there are various fields/filters to narrow your search:
  - Choose from the various Show Me selections. Items available for Show Me are: All, My Commodities, Open, Closing Soon, Recently Published, Recent Amendments, Recent Intents, & Recent Awards.
2. Keyword Search
  - The Keyword Search will search through all details of the grant opportunity which may not be seen on the first display screen.
3. Status
  - Items available for Status are: Awarded, Closed, Amended, Open, Reopened, Cancelled.
4. Type
  - Choosing a Type is not necessary as all grant funding opportunities will be listed by default.

### Grant Opportunity Results Display

Within the Grant Opportunities results display, you may expand a grant opportunity to review quick details of the opportunity such as description of grant program, coordinator, and date information. Clicking **Respond** from a transaction within the search results will take you directly to filling out the grant application.

Within the Grant Opportunity View Page, you may select the **Grant Opportunity Number GFO ID Number** hyperlink to review the grant opportunity details including General Information, Attachments, Grant Terms and Conditions, Evaluation Criteria, Events, Amendment History and Award History (currently labeled as Public Bid Reading). Users may print the grant opportunity by selecting the page-level **3-dot menu**, then **Print Grant Opportunity**, which will display the full details of the grant information.



## Grant Opportunity Response Options

There are two options to respond to grant opportunities:

### 1. **Respond Online** from within the Grant Opportunity View Page (GFO)

- a. Review information related to the grant opportunity. Select **Respond Online** at the top of the page.
- b. Select **Continue** or the **Respond to Lines** section. Generally, this is where the total requested amount of the grant opportunity is required per grant commodity line. Additional comments may be added.
- c. Select **Continue** or the **Requested Information** section. This information usually contains specific questions related to the grant opportunity or required grantee information.
- d. Select the **Service Area & Comments** section. The grant opportunity may require that you include an area where the grant activities will be performed. The areas listed are by county and on the last page includes additional options such as Statewide, Lower Peninsula and Upper Peninsula. You may select more than one area. To add Service Area(s) click **Find Service Areas**.
  - The Overall Application Comments section is an area to include more information related to the grant application or respond to additional questions that might be a part of the required application instructions.
- e. To add attachments click **Add Attachments**.
  - The grant opportunity may require an official application or supporting documentation.
- f. Select the **Review & Submit** section.
  - 1) The entire application and responses should be included to review in summary format before submitting your application.
    - There is an option to print the application summary within Print Application, as well as save, if you are not completed with your application and need to return later to update and submit.
  - 2) If the application is ready for submission, click **Submit Application**.
    - A message will appear that the application has been submitted.

### 2. **Print Application**

Some grant opportunities may allow or require a printed grant application that must be printed, filled out and mailed per instructions within the grant application. These instructions are included within the Grant Opportunity View Page (GFO) – by clicking the



Grant Opportunity Number/Type/Category GFO hyperlink from the Grant Opportunities search results. Select **Print Application** from the Grant Opportunity View Page (GFO).

### 3.1 My Watch List

The My Watchlist option (from the left-hand navigation menu, Grant Opportunities (Landing Page), then My Watchlist), allows you to select grant opportunities to monitor. The My Watchlist option allows you to view and maintain a list of all the grant opportunities you have selected to monitor in one area.

You can add grant opportunities to the My Watchlist area by selecting the page-level **3-dot menu** and **Add to Watchlist** on the Grant Opportunity View Page (GFO) of the Grant Opportunity transaction. Once added, the transaction is available on the My Watchlist area- until you remove it by selecting Delete. The grant opportunity transaction can also be removed from the My Watchlist area by selecting the page-level **3-dot menu**, then **Remove From Watchlist** on the Grant Opportunities Details page, where available. Closed opportunities also appear on the Search My Watchlist page until you delete the request. Archived opportunities do not appear on your Search My Watchlist page.

Select My Watchlist from the Left-Hand Navigation Menu under Grant Opportunities to verify the grant opportunity is listed.

### 3.2 Award History

**Award History:** Displays award history summary detail for all grant opportunities from the **Left-hand navigation menu**, **Grant Opportunities**, and **Award History**. You may narrow this list by choosing a Grant Code and clicking **Search**. You may also search for a specific grant award using the Keyword Search option. Only basic information is listed here, including Total Amount of award, to whom and for which grant opportunity. Other options to view Award History are within the Grant Opportunity View Page (GFO) within the **Components** tab and from the [SIGMA VSS](#) home page – prior to logging in (from the Banner – What would you like to do? section).



## Section 4: Grant Applications

### 4.1 My Grant Applications

Once a grant opportunity application has been responded to online, the application is stored within the **My Grant Applications** quick link of SIGMA VSS home page. Once located from the search, there are hyperlinks for the **Link to Application** and the **Grant Opportunity ID** field results. The various grid columns provide important details such as Application Status, Application Date, Grant Opportunity Status and Grant Opportunity Closing Date.

#### Search Options

There are multiple links and search options available to assist with searching for a specific grant application including:

1. Type in **Keyword Search** field to filter/narrow your results
  - Keyword will search through all details of the grant opportunity which may not be seen on the first display screen.
2. Filter by **Application Status**.
3. Choose the **Show More** link to search using additional fields
4. Click **Search**.
5. Click the **Next** arrow to scroll through the various pages

#### Application Status

The **Application Status** field displays the corresponding value from the Application Status field on the grantor transaction submitted from SIGMA VSS. This field is set as follows:

- **Draft** – Grant application is created but not yet submitted.
- **Submitted** – Grant application is submitted.
- **In Review** – Grant application is being reviewed by the Coordinator.
- **Clarification Requested** – Coordinator has requested that additional clarifying information be provided for the application. Allows edits to previously submitted application if a clarification request has been requested. Application updates must be submitted prior to the Clarification Due Date that is displayed in the Clarification



Request section of the GFA Link to Application hyperlink. Clarifications can only be requested by the coordinator after the application close date.

- **No Award, Approved or Substantially Approved** - Set by the Coordinator after the application has been reviewed as part of the evaluation process and a grant has/has not been awarded.
- **Withdrawn** – Grant application is withdrawn from consideration.

The Status field displays the Grant Opportunity Status such as Open or Closed.

## 4.2 Events Schedule Search

Click the **left-hand navigation menu**, **Grant Application**, and **Events Schedule Search**. The Events Schedule Search displays important events such as report deadlines or award acceptance language. When utilized, Event Schedules will be posted by the award coordinator. You may query events using the Search field then click **Apply**. The Events Schedule Search page displays a list of schedules that are associated with the grantee account.

The column fields listed within the Events Schedule Search results include:

- **Schedule ID** – When schedules are assigned, click the transaction-level **3-dot menu**, **Related Pages**, and **Grant Events**. This transitions you to the Grant Events page to view more detailed information about the Grant Event Schedule.
- **Schedule Name** - Name associated with the schedule.
- **Opportunity Description** - Grant opportunity information.
- **Opportunity & Application/Award** - The Grant Funding Opportunity and Grant Funding Application/Award transactions associated with the grant schedule display as hyperlinks and allow you to navigate directly to the transaction information from this page.
- **Total Events** - Number of events tied to the Grant Events Schedule ID.
- **In Progress/Completed Events** - Number of events tied to the Grant Event Schedule ID that have at least one event record.
- **Past Due Events** - Number of events tied to the Grant Events Schedule ID that do not have a record with a Status of Submitted or Approved where the Due Date for the grant event is past the application's system date.

From the page level **3-dot menu**, **Related Actions**, the **Events Schedule** provides the following links:

- **All Events** – displays all events for this Grant Events Schedule id.



- **Past Due Events** – displays all events that have a status other than Submitted or Approved and the Grant Event Schedule Due Date is not blank and less than the application's system date.
- **Rejected Events** – displays events that have a Status of Rejected.
- **In Progress Events** – displays events that have a Status of Draft.
- **Completed Events** – displays events that have a Status of Approved.
- **Acceptance Events** – displays events that have the Acceptance Required? value equal to Yes on the Grant Events Schedule Event Codes table.

## 4.3 Grant Reports

The **Grant Reports Search** page, within the **Grant Opportunities/Grant Application** section of the **left-hand navigation menu**, displays a list of grant event acceptance or report records that are associated with the grantee account.

The Grant Funding Opportunity (**GFO**) **transaction** under Opportunity/Description and the Grant Funding Application (**GFA**) **transaction** under Application/Award are displayed as hyperlinks so that you can navigate directly to the transaction information from this page. This page also includes the ability for grantees to access attachments associated with the grant event acceptance or report record, including attachments made as part of the grant report submission.

There are various search options within the Grant Reports Search page including:

1. **Status** – Use the dropdown list of status values to filter your search.
  - **Draft** – Grant report has been created but has not yet been submitted.
  - **In Review** – Grant report has been submitted and is being reviewed by the grant coordinator.
  - **Submitted** – Grant report has been submitted.
  - **Clarification Needed** – Grant coordinator has requested additional information to be provided regarding the grant report.
  - **Clarification Provided** – Grantee has provided the additional information requested by the grant coordinator.
  - **Approved** – Grant report has been approved.
  - **Rejected** – Grant report has been rejected.
  - **Restricted** - Grant report has been restricted.



2. **Event Description** – Enter keyword(s) to locate Grant Reports when searching by Event Description. Wildcard values (\*) are allowed.
3. **Report ID** – Grant Report records matching the entered Report ID are displayed. If you do not know the exact Report ID, wildcard values are allowed.
4. **Schedule ID** – Grant Report records matching the entered Schedule ID are displayed.
5. **Schedule Name** - Enter keyword(s) to locate Grant Reports when searching by Schedule Name. Wildcard values are allowed.
6. **Opportunity Description** - Enter keyword(s) to locate Grant Reports when searching by Opportunity Description. Wildcard values are allowed.
7. **Submit Date From** – Grant Report records where the Submit Date is equal or greater than the entered value is displayed.
8. **Submit Date To** – Grant Report records where the Submit Date is equal or less than the entered value is displayed.

#### **Details and Summary:**

Within the Grants Reports Search, select the transaction-level **3-dot menu**, **Related Pages**, and additional **Details** or **Summary**. Details show more information about the selected grant report.

- When a grant report is selected and you select **Details**, you are taken to the Grant Report entry page.
- When a grant report is selected, and you select **Summary**, you are taken to the Grant Events page which is filtered to display the selected grant event's schedule information.



## Section 5: Financial Inquiries

### 5.1 Financial Inquiries

The Financial Inquiries Landing page, located from the Left-hand navigation menu, is used to submit Grant Funding Requests (GFR), view status of previously submitted GFRs, view the status of Scheduled Payments, view Check/EFT payment information or to view Tax Information.

### 5.2 Agreements

From the left-hand navigation menu – Financial Inquiries, the Agreements page under My Transactions is used to select the grant transaction ID for which a GFR is being submitted. When clicking on the drop down in the **Agreement Type** field, a list of types of agreements are displayed: Contracts, Delivery Order, Master Agreement, Purchase Order and Grant Award. For grant agreements, the **Grant Award** option is chosen.

After choosing Grant Award in the Agreement Type field, click the **Apply** button.

SIGMA VSS will display a list of Grant Awards with additional information provided: Agreement Type, Department, Agreement ID, Tracking Number, Transaction Date, Outstanding and more.

After **Apply** is clicked, choose a Grant Award by clicking the transaction-level **3-dot menu** and choose one of the **Related Pages**: Details, Reference, Create Request, or **Related Actions**: PDF to see more information on the Grant Award.

#### 5.2.1 Create Request (GFR)

Selecting the **3-dot menu**, **Related Pages**, and **Create Request** will begin the process to create the GFR to request payment of grant funds.

There are four sections required for completing a GFR:

- **Header Information**
- **Component Information**
- **Comments and Attachments**
- **Funding Request Summary**



When Create Request is clicked, the GFR transaction is created and opens to the **Header Information** section.

On this section, the only required information to populate is the **Total Amount** field. Enter the total amount to be requested (Example:1000.00 do not include \$ sign). Payment Address and Contact Information will auto-populate but can be changed if needed at this time.

When all the information needed is populated, click **Continue** to move to the next section. SIGMA VSS will then transition to the Component Information tab.

If there are multiple components, they will show up within this section. Once the **Line Number box is checked** on a component line, the **Amount** field will open to add the amount requested. If Budget type categories (**Category** field) are also being used within component lines, choose the drop down to include each amount requested by category.

Select **Add Line** at the top of the page if additional lines are required. Please note that only one existing Component Line's Line Number box can be checked when trying to add additional lines and the total number of lines needed will have to be added prior to populating any information within any component line, because information will clear anytime the Line Number box is unchecked for a component line.

Update **Period From** and **Period To** dates per grant agreement conditions or dates of funding period request.

The **Comments** field is an optional field and can be populated but is not required.

Once all component lines are added as needed, click **Continue** (Note: A warning message may be received related to funding request if the amounts do not match or the request is not for the full amount remaining. These are warnings only and will not prevent the submission of the GFR.) SIGMA VSS will then transition to the **Comments/Attachments** section.

Most requests will require additional documentation, which can be attached here along with any additional comments (up to 60 characters) that the grantee provides.

Additional documentation/attachments can be added by clicking the Add Attachments button in the upper right corner of this page. The Attachments Page allows you to Drag and Drop or Browse to upload files. Once the attachment files have been loaded, click **Upload**, then **Close** to add the files to the GFR transaction.

Once all attachments and comments have been added, add **Additional Comments** as applicable and click **Continue**. SIGMA VSS will then transition to the **Funding Request Summary** section.

This section provides the grantee with a summary of the information populated on the previous 3 sections of the transaction. It is at this time that the grantee can click **Submit Request** to submit the GFR into the payment process. (Optionally, the grantee may also select **Cancel Request** to cancel the GFR or select **Previous** to go back to prior sections to update information before submitting.) SIGMA VSS will then transition to a **Thank You!** page.



The **Thank You!** page displays additional information on how to check the status on the submitted request. There is also an option to **Print** the request which will create a PDF version of the summary page.

If you need assistance with this process, please contact the [SIGMA Help Desk](#).

### 5.3 Scheduled Payments

From the left-hand navigation menu – Financial Inquiries, the Scheduled Payment page under My Transactions is used to view scheduled payment information for grant funding requests. Refer to the Help (Question mark icon) at the top of the page in VSS for more information on the Scheduled Payments functionality. Click Apply to view all Scheduled Payments or enter specific search criteria in the fields shown. (Example: Invoice/Request Number, Address ID, Department, Payment Scheduled From, Payment Scheduled To, Payment Status fields.) Please note that if there are no payments currently scheduled, the user will receive a “No Results Found” reply when you click Apply.

### 5.4 Checks/EFTs

Enter search criteria and click **Apply** to find your checks and EFT payments. The wildcard \* may be used before or after your search to broaden your results. For each payment in the search results, use the transaction-level **3-dot menu** to access payment **details**, view **referenced** agreement and payment information, or download a **PDF**. You can search for Check/EFT for the past 3 years. Search is limited to 2,000 results, use other search parameters to narrow records.

### 5.5 Invoice Summary Page

From the left-hand navigation menu – Financial Inquiries, the Invoice Summary Search page under My Transactions is used to search for existing GFRs. Note: Creation of GFRs can also be accessed from this page by clicking the page-level **3-dot menu**, then **Create Invoice/Request**. SIGMA VSS will then automatically redirect to the Agreement Summary Search page.

To view additional information, such as the Agreement ID that is associated with a GFR payment, click the Grant Award transaction-level **3-dot menu**, **Related Pages**, then **Reference**.

SIGMA VSS will then display the **Referenced Agreements by Scheduled Payment** page, which provides a summary view of the Agreements, Scheduled Payments and Checks/EFTs sections for the selected GFR transaction.

To return to the Invoice/Request Summary Search page, click **Back**.

To download the payment information related to the selected GFR transaction, click the transaction-level **3-dot menu**, **Related Actions**, then **PDF**. SIGMA VSS will then download the



Grant Funding Request summary. This summary will display the information provided on the created GFR.

The **Invoice/Request Status** field displays the corresponding value based on the status of the request. The possible statuses are:

- Approved – All invoices/requests that are Final in SIGMA and have an open balance will display a status of *Approved*.
- Cancelled - When a cancellation version of an invoice/request has been submitted to Final in SIGMA, the system displays a status of *Cancelled* in VSS. The system also displays a status of *Cancelled* for invoices/requests that have been submitted via VSS, transmitted to SIGMA but then a user discards the Draft transaction in SIGMA before the transaction is processed to Final. If an invoice/request is cancelled in SIGMA, the user cancelling the transaction will notify the grantee and the grantee will have to submit a new invoice/request.
- Paid – All invoices/requests display a status of *Paid* when one or more lines have been disbursed.
- Payment Held – All invoices/requests that have a referenced Payment Request that has been submitted to Final but not yet disbursed and the payment request has been held, display a status of *Payment Held*.
- Payment Scheduled – All invoices/requests that have a referenced Payment Request that has been submitted to Final but not yet disbursed and the payment request has not been held, display a status of *Payment Scheduled*.
- Pending Approval – All invoices/requests that have been submitted in VSS, reflected in SIGMA but have not been processed to Final display a status of *Pending Approval*. Invoices/requests submitted in VSS are the only transactions that can display a *Pending Approval* status.
- Rejected - All Invoices/requests that have a referenced Payment Request that has been rejected by the coordinator.
- Submitted – All invoices/requests that have been submitted in SIGMA VSS but not yet reflected in SIGMA.